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Branding is what people say about you when you are not in the room.



-Jeff Bezos



earn globally recognised Arduino certifications to showcase their skills professionally.

What types of projects will students be able to create upon completing the programme?

Arduino offers a wide range of boards for IoT, AI and machine learning, robotics, and industrial applications. For industry, it provides products suitable for PLC-style automation, while robotics options include the Alvik robot and the India-made Arduino Uno R4, enhancing local availability.

Will faculty be involved in guiding students in this lab, or will mentorship come exclusively from industry leaders in IoT?

Faculty members form the backbone of the ecosystem, mentoring students across diverse hardware, from advanced Pro series boards to AI/ML and small-form-factor boards. They guide startups in refining problem statements and help students build domain-specific skills.

How will Manav Rachna support startups or student ventures emerging from this innovation hub?

A Section 8 vertical has been established to support startups, guiding students from ideation through mentoring to seed funding. The three pillars—mentoring, funding, and market access—ensure that students receive expert guidance, access to seed funds, and industry connections to develop and scale their ventures effectively.

How do you plan to measure the success of students, through job placements, patents, or the creation of new businesses?

While startups face challenges and may not always generate early revenue, they can create valuable intellectual property (IP) such as patents, copyrights, and trademarks. Students are encouraged to secure

their innovations through proper IPR, with guidance provided for filing patents and other protections.

Initiatives such as AICTE's KAPILA programme support awareness and funding for IPR activities. Emphasising a professional approach to IP has helped many student startups add significant value to their ventures.

Will this opportunity also be available to students who are not enrolled at Manav Rachna International University?

Our focus extends beyond Manav Rachna's internal students and faculty to the wider community and ecosystem of tech enthusiasts, innovators, and entrepreneurs. The initiative is open to collaboration and support, offering guidance on building projects, setting up labs, and ensuring long-term success.

During the event, two products were launched: the Vande IoT platform and the Arduino Uno R4 book. Could you please elaborate on these?

The collaboration with Arduino began with the launch of the Uno R4 board in India. Recognising the need for India-focused content, a book was developed featuring 25 experiments and activities, complete with code, covering advanced features such as ARM Cortex M4, SPI, I2C, ADC/DAC, PWM, and Arduino Cloud integration for real-time IoT projects.

Simultaneously, Vande IoT (vandeiot.in) was launched, which is a free cloud platform with APIs and a drag-and-drop dashboard builder, making IoT innovation accessible to students, faculty, and industry professionals while removing financial barriers. **EFY**

This interview is an excerpt of a longer discussion. For the full transcript, please visit: <https://efy.co.in/intDec25>

